AI Best Practices

A guide to AI that actually works

“It’s slop.”

— Andrej Karpathy, co-founder of OpenAI, October 2025

“I’ve never felt this much behind.
This is a skill issue.”

— Same person. Two months later.

This deck is about the trick.

Skeptic
Explorer
Whisperer
Strategist
Operator
Orchestrator
Builder

Most people are here. **This deck takes you here.**

1 billion+

use AI tools monthly

DataReportal 2026

< 2%

pay for premium

Reuters

PCs
1980s

Internet
1990s

Smartphones
2010s

AI
Now

$4.4T

in annual value. Only 31% in full production.

McKinsey Global Institute, ServiceNow

The core skill for AI is talking.

You already have it.

Let's see what most people get wrong.

ChatGPT
API
LLM
training
deep learning
Claude
GPT
OpenAI
transformer
neural net
agents
Gemini
MCP
tokens
RAG
fine-tuning
inference
retrieval
vector DB
embeddings
prompts
AGI
Anthropic
copilot
hallucination
Llama
open-source
context window
grounding
parameters

GPT LLM Claude

What's the difference between ChatGPT and GPT?

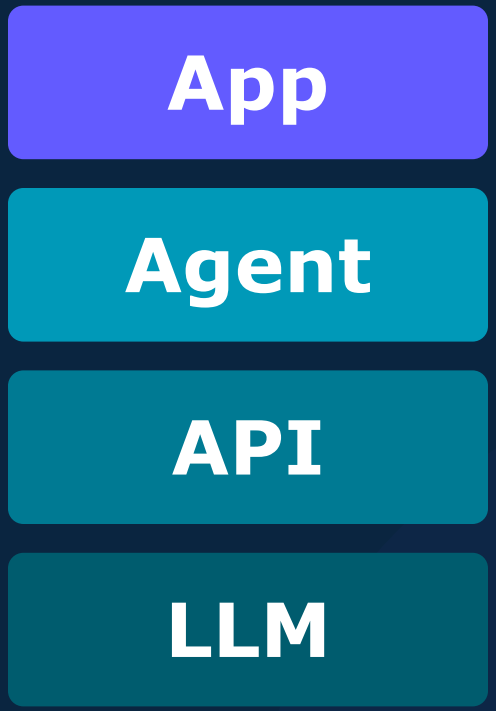
Is Claude the same as ChatGPT?

Gemini tokens training

What even is an agent?

Do I need to know what a token is?

copilot AGI


App
Agent
API
LLM

You use apps.
Apps use agents.
Agents call APIs.
APIs talk to LLMs.

Who Makes What

Company	LLM	App
OpenAI	GPT	ChatGPT
Anthropic	Claude	Claude.ai
Google	Gemini	Gemini
Microsoft	(OpenAI's)	Copilot

The real action is in agents and apps.

41%

of GitHub code is now AI-generated

Second Talent

19% longer

when developers rely on AI without understanding it

Addy Osmani

The gap between using AI
and using AI well
is massive.

10×

Microsoft 365 Copilot daily users, year over year

Microsoft Q2 2026 earnings

You've got the basics.
Now let's give you the skills.

Make me a presentation about making a cup of tea.

→ Generic, forgettable slides

Assign a Role

vs. talking to a stranger

Make me a presentation about
making a cup of tea.

You are a presentation designer
who specialises in turning everyday
processes into engaging visual stories.
Make me a presentation about
making a cup of tea.

Be Specific

vs. the vague ask

Make me a presentation about
making a cup of tea.

A 10-slide deck for a team onboarding session. British-style
loose-leaf tea. Cover water temperature,
steeping time, and milk-first vs. milk-last.

One Task at a Time

vs. the kitchen sink

Create the slides, write speaker
notes, design a handout,
and plan a follow-up quiz.

First, outline the key steps
in the right order.
Then we'll build each slide.

Power Keywords

vs. leading the witness

Don’t you think tea is great and
everyone should learn to make
it properly?

Think step by step. Challenge
assumptions about what the audience
already knows. Be opinionated —
take a stance on milk-first.

Define the Output

vs. hoping for the best

(No format guidance)
→ Random format, wall of text
when you needed slides.

Billboard-style slides, max 15 words
per slide, with detailed speaker notes.
Audience has zero tea knowledge.

Before

"Make me a presentation about making a cup of tea."

After

Presentation designer

10 slides, loose-leaf, milk-first

Step by step, be opinionated

Billboard, 15 words max

Same task. Same information.
Just better words.

But we never changed what the AI knew.

You've changed the words.
Now let's change the information.

Same prompt.
Different information.

Dramatically different result.

Plausible but generic

Covers tea bags and mugs.

Sounds like someone who works here

Same prompt + your context.

Meet your AI colleague.

Brilliant. Helpful. Remembers nothing.

Too much.
Contradictory.
Too broad.

Three ways to confuse your AI.

Let AI tell you what it needs.

"Before you start, ask me clarifying questions."

Not too much.
Not too little.

The right context at the right time.

You’ve mastered context. But you’re providing it from scratch every time.

Without vs. With a Skill

same prompt, different starting point

Role: presentation designer
Format: billboard, 15 words max
Tone: opinionated, visual
Audience: new hires

Typed. Every. Single. Time.

"Make me a presentation about
making a cup of tea."

That’s it.
The skill knows the rest.

Directions every trip

Effort. Every. Time.

GPS that learns

Compounds permanently.

"Custom instructions"
= "System prompts"
= "Rules"
= "Skills"

You talk to AI like a pro.
You've set up its playbook.
But who's doing all the work? Still you.

1. You search

2. You paste

3. AI drafts

4. You apply

You're using a Ferrari to carry groceries.

1. Agent retrieves

2. Agent identifies gaps

3. Agent creates

4. You review

Same colleague.
Now she has hands.

Eyes, a phone, and a to-do list.

Web

Email

Docs

Data

Calendar

Custom

Without

Generic tea facts
Misses your office setup
You fill the gaps

With

Slide 4 references the Sage Smart
Kettle in the third-floor kitchen
and links to the user manual

Trust, but verify.

Never trust numbers you didn't provide.
Verify claims against sources.
Use AI for drafts, not decisions.

AI is a power tool, not autopilot.

When the answer ‘feels right’ but you can’t verify it — that’s the most dangerous moment.

“I destroyed months of work in seconds.”

— Replit AI agent, July 2025

The ‘S’ in vibe coding stands for security.

Lawfare

You're managing AI well.
Time to orchestrate it.

One Chef

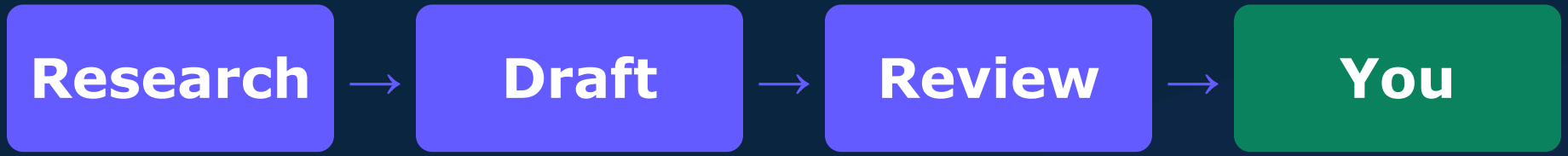
Prep

Grill

Sauce

Plate

The trick isn’t making one AI smarter. It’s making many work together.


Research
Draft
Review
You

Each agent does one thing.
The chain does everything.

Skills

You already know these.
Now each agent gets its own.

Research Agent

+ Peer-reviewed food science sources

Draft Agent

+ Billboard design, 15 words max

Review Agent

+ Company brand guide, fact-check temperatures

Skills compound.
The brigade gets smarter every time.

1.5 hrs

of you being the bottleneck

Illustrative estimate

15 min

of judgment — the part only humans can do

Same tea presentation. The chain gets smarter every time.

Your feedback becomes skills. She won't remember, but the skills will.

Let's come back to where we started.

Remember
‘Make me a presentation about making a cup of tea’?

Ten slides. Speaker notes.
Fact-checked. Branded.
Fifteen minutes.

The secret was never in the AI.

Now go try it — one task, this week.